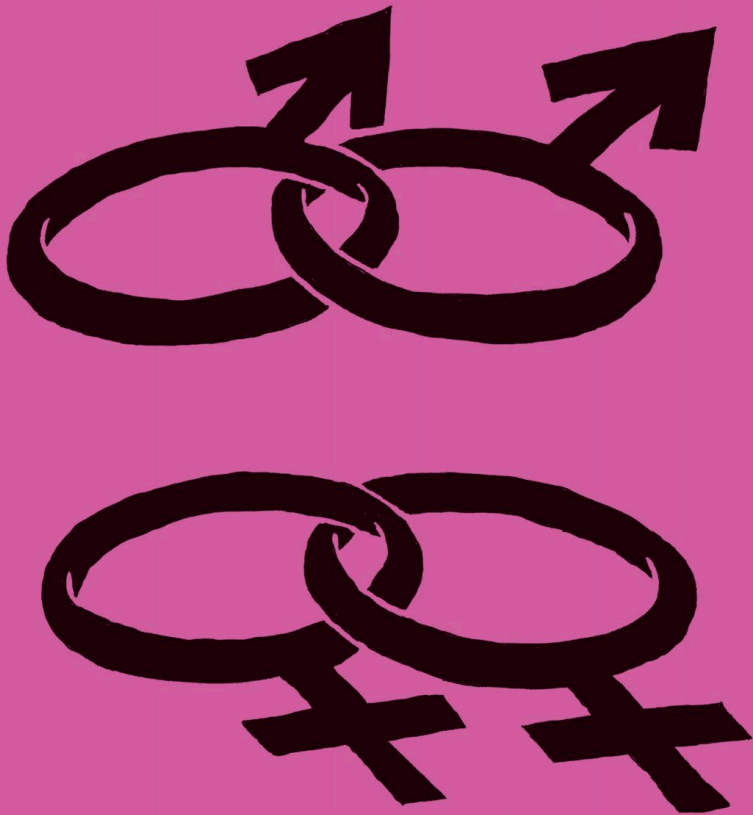


MARRIAGE SHOULD BE OPEN TO ALL

SAME-SEX MARRIAGE (2000)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Civil rights

BEFORE

1791 Revolutionary France declares homosexuality legal.

1969 The Stonewall Riots in New York highlight the plight of homosexuals in the US.

1996 The Defense of Marriage Act allows US states not to recognize same-sex marriages.

AFTER

2004 The UK passes the Civil Partnership Act.

2015 The US Supreme Court upholds the right to same-sex marriage in every US state.

2017 Anti-homosexual purges are launched in the Russian republic of Chechnya.

2019 The Iranian Minister of Foreign Affairs openly defends execution for homosexuality.

In a blaze of publicity that included live television coverage, the world's first legal same-sex marriages took place in the Netherlands on April 1, 2001, after legislation was passed in 2000 to allow them. The weddings of four couples—three male, one female—demonstrated a historic embrace of gay rights by one of the most tolerant countries in the world.

The campaign for same-sex partnerships to be recognized in law reached a milestone in 1989, when Denmark became the first country to introduce civil unions. A civil union confers similar or identical rights as marriage in areas such as tax benefits, pensions, and inheritance,